

**Development at
3 Woden Road
Wolverhampton
WV10 0AU**

**Wolverhampton Borough
Council**

Transport Statement

September 2025



Contents

1	Introduction	4
2	Planning Policy	5
3	Existing Conditions	12
4	Proposed Development	15
5	Summary and Conclusions	15

1 Introduction

Introduction

This Transport Statement has been commissioned on behalf of GT Designz Limited to accompany a planning application for demolition of side extension, ground floor rear extension And COU to 6 person HMO with associated bins & cycle facilities @ 3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton, WV10 0AU

- 1.1 A location plan is included in **Appendix A** and a proposed site layout is included in **Appendix B**.
- 1.2 This Transport Statement has been prepared in accordance with the relevant Planning Practice Guidance National Guidance Statement and draft supplementary Planning Document (SPD).

Pre-application advice

- 1.3 Pre-application discussions have not taken place with Wolverhampton City Council.

Report contents

- 1.4 This report includes:
 - Section 2 on policy;
 - Section 3 describes existing conditions;
 - Section 4 describes the proposals;
 - Section 5 describes proposed Travel Planning measures to help ensure the site is accessible and sustainable;
 - Section 6 describes the expected non-vehicular impacts;
 - Section 7 describes the expected traffic impacts; and
 - Section 8 summarises and concludes the report.

2 Planning Policy

Introduction

- 2.1 This section describes relevant planning policy: The National Planning Policy Framework and Wolverhampton Borough Council's Local Plan.

National Planning Policy Framework

- 2.2 Paragraph 10 of the NPPF states:

"At the heart of the National Planning Policy Framework is a presumption in favour of sustainable development"

- 2.3 Section 9 of the NPPF on promoting sustainable transport includes advice on considering development proposals:

"In assessing sites that may be allocated for development in plans, or specific applications for development, it should be ensured that:

a) appropriate opportunities to promote sustainable transport modes can be – or have been – taken up, given the type of development and its location;

b) safe and suitable access to the site can be achieved for all users; and

c) any significant impacts from the development on the transport network (in terms of capacity and congestion), or on highway safety, can be cost effectively mitigated to an acceptable degree.

- 2.4 Paragraph 109 states:

"Development should only be prevented or refused on highways grounds if there would be an unacceptable impact on highway safety, or the residual cumulative impacts on the road network would be severe."

- 2.5 Paragraph 111 states:

"All developments that will generate significant amounts of movement should be required to provide a travel plan, and the application should be supported by a transport statement or transport assessment so that the likely impacts of the proposal can be assessed."

Black country Core Strategy -Supplementary Planning Guidance

TRANSPORT AND ACCESSIBILITY

TRAN1

Priorities for the Development of the Transport Network

Spatial Objectives The delivery of an improved and integrated transport network both within the Black Country and in links with regional and national networks is fundamental to achieving the Vision and in helping to transform the area, deliver housing growth and improve economic performance, and achieving Spatial Objective 7

TRAN1

3.1 Policy The development of transport networks in the Black Country is focused on a step change in public transport provision serving and linking centres, improving sustainable transport facilities and services across the area, improving connectivity to national networks and improving the efficiency of strategic highway routes. Land needed for the implementation of priority transport projects will be safeguarded in order to assist in their future implementation. All new developments will address the transport network and provide adequate access for all modes, including walking, cycling and public transport. Residential development will be expected to meet the accessibility standards set out in Policy HOU2.

Given uncertainty over the availability of future funding for major transport infrastructure over the longer term, continuing priority will be given to improving transport in key corridors through the roll out of the Smarter Routes initiative that embraces a range of techniques for improving public transport, traffic management (including localised junction improvements), road safety and facilities for cyclists and pedestrians.

The improvements needed to deliver the transport strategy are shown on the Transport Key Diagram.

The key transport priorities are:

- Providing rapid transit extensions to the Midland Metro to connect the Black Country Strategic Centres to each other and to Birmingham – first priority being within the Walsall to Stourbridge corridor, providing high quality access to Merry Hill and Brierley Hill;
- Improving Junctions 1 and 2 of M5;
- Improving Junctions 9 and 10 of M6;
- Active Traffic Management and Hard Shoulder Running on M6;
- Delivering a Quality Bus Network across the Black Country, particularly Brierley Hill;
- Improving access from the Black Country to Birmingham International Airport;
- New freight railways between Stourbridge and Walsall and Walsall to Lichfield; • Burnt Tree Junction;
- A41 Expressway / A4031 All Saints junction;
- Wolverhampton Interchange;
- Metro Line 1 Improvements and Wolverhampton Strategic Centre Extension;
- West Bromwich Regeneration Road;
- I54 link;
- Red Routes Package 1 and 2;
- Darlaston SDA access scheme. Priority will also be given to the implementation of the priority public transport projects identified in the West Midlands Local Transport Plan, particularly Smart Routes, local rail improvements, transport interchanges and Park and Ride sites, including:
 - Improved Rail Passenger Services;
 - Walsall to Wolverhampton passenger rail;

- Walsall to Cannock rail line;
- New railway stations at Aldridge and Willenhall. Other corridors where the public transport demand would support rapid transit include:
- Stourbridge to Brierley Hill;
- A456 Hagley Road from Birmingham to Quinton;
- A449 Stafford Road from Wolverhampton to I54;
- A34 Walsall to Birmingham

Good connectivity to the wider region national transport networks and Birmingham International Airport for both passengers and freight has been identified as being necessary to support the regeneration of the Black Country. The economic growth will be supported by improved access to major global economies.

3.2 A strategic public transport “spine” comprising high quality, reliable, fast and high capacity rapid transit between the strategic centres - Brierley Hill, Walsall, West Bromwich, Wolverhampton and Birmingham is considered as a crucial element of the Strategy and is necessary to support the expansion of these centres as a focus for employment, shopping and leisure. The Black Country Public Transport Spine has been identified as one of the 9 Regional Transport Priorities. Currently Metro line 1 provides the required standard of link between Wolverhampton, West Bromwich and Birmingham but it is important that the public transport modes of rail, metro and bus are better integrated to ensure that people can use them to travel where and when they need to.

3.3 It is vital that new development has access to high quality public transport facilities and services from the outset as this will ensure that people travelling to and from these areas do not establish unsustainable travel patterns due to the initial absence of good public transport.

3.4 The Core Strategy supports the delivery of an enhanced transport network for the Black Country to ensure a seamless integration of land-use and transport planning and to demonstrate the strong interdependency of future land-use decisions and adequate servicing by a variety of travel modes. The exact mode of public transport should reflect existing demand and also take account of potential future economic or housing growth points to ensure an integrated approach to sustainable development and travel patterns. This is essential to support the scale of growth proposed for the regeneration corridors and strategic centres and to create an effective transportation system to support sustainable communities. This transport network will provide communities with access to employment, leisure, education and health care and will facilitate improved access to employment sites. Public Transport will be at the heart of these proposals with a Black Country rapid transit spine connecting the centres of Brierley Hill, Walsall, West Bromwich, Wolverhampton and Birmingham as well as delivering greatly improved accessibility to the Regeneration Corridors as shown on the Transport Key Diagram.

Managing Transport Impacts of New Development

Planning permission will not be granted for development proposals that are likely to have significant transport implications unless applications are accompanied by proposals to provide an acceptable level of accessibility and safety by all modes of transport to and from all parts of a development including, in particular, access by walking, cycling, public transport and car sharing. These proposals should be in accordance with an agreed Transport Assessment, where required, and include implementation of measures to promote and improve such sustainable transport facilities through agreed Travel Plans and similar measures.

3.5 All developments will be assessed both in terms of their impact on the transport network and the opportunities that could be available to ensure that the site is accessible by sustainable modes of transport. The supporting documentation will either take the form of a full Transport Assessment (TA) or a less detailed Transport Statement (TS) and will generally be determined by the size and scale of development or land use. This will be based on Appendix B of the DfT Guidance on Transport Assessment, although a TA may be required instead of a TS for a range of other reasons (for example road safety concerns, existing congestion problems, air quality problems, concerns over community severance or likelihood of off-site parking being generated). Where a development is considered to have a potential significant effect on the Primary Route Network then the Highways Agency will be involved.

3.6 Depending on the size, nature and location of the development the TA will need to make recommendations for a range of Travel Plan (TP) measures that are capable of achieving either significantly lower than average traffic levels or reduced levels of car use. A Travel Plan is a long term management strategy for an occupier or site that seeks to deliver sustainable transport objectives through positive action and is set out in a document that is regularly reviewed and up-dated. Travel Plans will normally be secured as planning obligations and/or planning conditions along with any remedial transport measures required due to the potential impact of the development.

3.7 The scope of the Travel Plan will be determined by the size, scale and nature of the development, the findings of the Transport Assessment or Statement and through pre application discussions. This will include developer funded mitigation measures which may need to be delivered.

The Efficient Movement of Freight Policy

The movement of freight by sustainable modes such as rail and waterways will be encouraged. Road based freight will be encouraged to use the Primary Route Network whenever this is practicable. Junction improvements and routing strategies will be focussed on those parts of the highway network particularly important for freight access to employment sites and to the motorway network.

Proposals which generate significant freight movements will be directed to sites with satisfactory access to the principal road network.

Existing and disused railway lines as shown on the Transport Key Diagram will be safeguarded for rail related uses. Sites with existing and potential access to the rail network for freight will be safeguarded for rail related uses.

3.8 Within the Black Country, freight traffic has always been particularly important reflecting the area's past level of manufacturing and it remains significant today with industry, distribution and logistics giving rise to much freight traffic. This is reflected in both the M5 and M6 motorways, where the proportion of heavy goods vehicles can be 30% of total traffic, and the local road network where the traffic on many main routes has an exceptionally high percentage of heavy goods vehicles.

3.9 Much of the primary route network in the Black Country was never designed to cope with modern heavy goods vehicles and this gives rise to problems of reliability and with deliveries and servicing. The Black Country Authorities are members of the West Midlands Freight Quality Partnership, as are freight operators and their national representative bodies.

3.10 The Regional Freight Strategy sets a context for planning for freight within the Black Country. Removal of freight from the road to rail or canal will reduce congestion, and support

investment in rail and canals. The railway network serving the Black Country suffers from capacity problems during the day when there is high demand for passenger services and this has shifted much freight traffic to night time operation.

3.11 Of the disused lines the most important is Stourbridge-Walsall-Lichfield which has been identified in the Regional Freight Strategy and the Region Rail Development Plan as being an important link for freight moving between the South West and North East regions. Locally, four sites have been identified as being suitable for rail connection if rail freight services are reinstated. Within the West Midlands conurbation the Stourbridge to Lichfield link would act as a bypass for the rail network around Birmingham which has severe capacity constraints. The capacity released by the reopening of Stourbridge, Walsall, Lichfield, as well as benefiting the freight network, would allow extra passenger services to operate to and through Birmingham to the benefit of the West Midlands region.

Policy Creating Coherent Networks for Cycling and for Walking

Joint working between the four local authorities will ensure that the Black Country has a comprehensive cycle network based on integrating the four local cycle networks, including common cycle infrastructure design standards.

Creating an environment that encourages sustainable travel requires new developments to link to existing walking and cycling networks. The links should be safe, direct and not impeded by infrastructure provided for other forms of transport. Where possible, existing links including the canal network should be enhanced and the networks extended to serve new developments. New developments should have good walking and cycling links to public transport nodes and interchanges.

Cycle parking facilities should be provided at all new developments and should be located in a convenient location with good natural surveillance, e.g. in close proximity of main front entrances for short stay visitors or under shelter for long stay visitors. The number of cycle parking spaces required will be determined by local standards in supplementary planning documents.

Spatial Objectives

The development of sustainable modes and encouraging people out of their cars, particularly for short and commuter journeys is an important element of Spatial Objectives 3, 5 and 7. Places need to be well connected with attractive, convenient, direct and safe routes available to users and providing real choice.

3.12 It is essential that the development of walking and cycling facilities are an integral part of the transport system both on the highway network, canal corridors, Public Rights of Way and on other paths. Comprehensive cycle and walking networks within the Black Country will enable communities to access employment, public transport interchanges, services and facilities in a sustainable way. A transport network that facilitates car use and disadvantages walking and cycling can adversely affect the health and well being of its communities. Identifying and overcoming barriers to walking and cycling during development processes will encourage a renaissance of walking and cycling within the Black Country and help improve the health and well being of local communities by reducing the incidence of obesity, coronary heart disease, strokes, and diabetes. Both walking and cycling are active modes of travel with clear health benefits. The implementation recognises the specific requirements of each with cycling provision mainly on carriageway and a comprehensive network of walking opportunities available both on highway and off road.

3.13 Walking and Cycling Strategies are incorporated within the West Midlands Local Transport Plan (LTP2) with a target to increase cycling by 1% by 2010/11. The four Black Country local authorities have their own walking and cycling strategies and use funding allocated through LTP2 to make infrastructure improvements.

3.14 A Black Country Cycle Network map has been developed to identify missing links and barriers between borough boundaries and authorities adjoining the Black Country.

3.15 In order to achieve a coherent Black Country cycle network the four local authorities have agreed to follow common cycle infrastructure design standards by adhering to Department for Transport publication 'Local Transport Note 2/08 Cycle Infrastructure Design.'

Influencing the Demand for Travel and Travel Choices

Policy The Black Country Local Authorities are committed to considering all aspects of traffic management in the centres and wider area in accordance with the Traffic Management Act 2004.

The priorities for traffic management in the Black Country are:

- The pricing of parking - ensuring that it is not used as a tool for competition between centres;
- The type of parking – ensuring that where appropriate long stay parking is removed near to town centres to support parking for leisure and retail customers and encourage commuters to use more sustainable means and reduce peak hour traffic flows;
- Maximum parking standards – ensuring that a consistent approach to maximum parking standards is enforced in new developments as set out in supplementary planning documents;
- The location of parking – by reviewing the location of town centre car parks through the "Network Management Duty Strategy" to ensure that the flow of traffic around the town centres is as efficient as possible; • Identifying appropriate strategic and local Park and Ride sites on current public transport routes to ease traffic flows into centres;
- Working together with the rest of the region to manage region-wide traffic flows through the West Midlands Metropolitan Area Urban Traffic Control (UTC) scheme and further joint working;
- Promoting and implementing Smarter Choices measures that will help to reduce the need to travel and facilitate a shift towards using sustainable modes of transport (walking, cycling, public transport, car sharing)

5.16 The correct balance needs to be found between managing and pricing parking to maximise the use of sustainable travel means to enter town and city centres, whilst avoiding restricting parking to the extent that consumers are dissuaded from using town centres and that new development is deterred. The Spatial Strategy aims at making the network of town and city centres as attractive and accessible as possible to encourage use the most sustainable modes.

3.17 Other important aspects of demand management are the prioritisation of allocation of road space towards sustainable methods of travel such as walking, cycling and buses by using schemes such as traffic calming measures and full or time limited pedestrianisation so making these modes more attractive to people visiting the centres

3.18 The correct balance needs to be found between managing and pricing parking to maximise the use of sustainable travel means to enter town and city centres, whilst avoiding restricting parking to the extent that consumers are dissuaded from using town centres and that new development is deterred. The Spatial Strategy aims at making the network of town and city centres as attractive and accessible as possible to encourage use the most sustainable modes.

3.19 Other important aspects of demand management are the prioritisation of allocation of road space towards sustainable methods of travel such as walking, cycling and buses by using schemes such as traffic calming measures and full or time limited pedestrianisation so making these modes more attractive to people visiting the centres.

3.20 Other important elements include the promotion and marketing of sustainable transport through travel plans (refer to Policy TRAN2), planning conditions / obligations and other associated Smarter Choices / TravelWise initiatives, including the promotion of schemes and opportunities for walking, cycling, public transport and car sharing.

3.21 These policies will reduce road traffic congestion and pollution, improve road safety, promote social inclusion and accessibility, therefore encouraging consumers to access the four strategic centres using sustainable transport.

4 Existing Conditions

Introduction

- 4.1 This section describes the existing site location and function and then provides the baseline information. This section includes local walking and cycling audits that demonstrate the accessibility of the site to non-car modes, along with Census data showing existing levels of car ownership and car use.

Site location, existing function, and access

- 4.2 Development at 3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton, WV10 0AU. Woden Road is in Wolverhampton in the West Midlands. 3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton, WV10 0AU is a semi-detached house.
- 4.3 The existing surrounding houses are occupied, and all existing parking is on-street. The surrounding site are detached and semi-detached houses and commercial units.

Existing highway network

- 4.4 The main road is 6m wide and has parking on both sides – please note the road is a two-way system.
- 4.5 There is ample parking of the Woden Road and neighboring roads. Woden Road has a signalized pedestrian and cycle crossing near the current site. The local streets are well lit and have 20 -30mph speed limits.

Access to local facilities

- 4.6 The site has excellent access to a wide range of local facilities. Rail stations, trams and bus stops near the site. It is important that the property is well connected by having rail/train stations, underground stations and bus stops nearby.

The closest bus stops are on Cannock Road Railway Bridge, 400 feet walk from the proposed site access. The nearest nursery and school is St Stephens, Church of England primary school and Woden Primary school and Tudor Medical Centre, Springfield Road, Wolverhampton which are 0.2 and 0.4 miles away from the application site. There are local shops including a Asda and other high street shops which are within 0.6 miles from the site. Bentley Bridge Retail Park and other retail shops are within 1 miles walk from the site and the tesco superstore is 1.4 miles away. There is a local bus which comes every 10 mins that will take you to Wolverhampton . Within short distance there also include a pub and post office. There is Lidl and many other shops that is within a 1 mile walk away. The closest Doctors surgery, Woden road Surgery and The Townsfield Doctors surgery and Kincora Doctors are 5 minutes away from the Applicant's site. There is a library on Kempthorne Avenue , which is 20 minutes walking distance away and few bus stops away.

- 4.7 There are a wide range of employment opportunities neighboring the site and a hospital near Woden Road. The local hospital is 0.9 miles away.

Walking

- 4.8 There are wide footpaths around the site on Woden Road.
- 4.9 All local facilities are easy to access on foot using the local footways.

Cycling

- 4.10 There is a local cycle lane on neighboring road that provides access north, south and east to the local shops and the local employment area.
- 4.11 New Cross Hospital and City Centre is a 1.2-mile cycle along Thorneycroft Lane, Wolverhampton. This route is approximately 1.2m to the Hospital and 1.2m to the city centre boundary. This is about 10 minutes cycle ride or about 15-20 minutes' walk.

Public Transport

- 4.12 The local bus stops on Railway Bridge, Cannock Road serve bus number 2,11,70 every 10 minutes per hour between Wolverhampton bus station to Warstones

Site accessibility, car ownership and modes of travel

- 4.13 The site is highly accessible to all local facilities. There are a range of local shops nearby and larger food stores such as Asda superstore within 0.6 mile and other shops of 0.1 miles hence Bentley Bridge Retail. The city center is 1.8 miles away. There is a significant amount of local employment within walking or cycling distance. Public Transport connections are excellent, with bus stops within walking distance serving a range of destinations including Wolverhampton and Warstones and other key destinations.
- 4.14 The 2011 Census data for the local area shows the local Lower Layer Super Output Area within which the site lies. This area includes the surrounding residential streets of Woden Road and streets to the east and west of this.
- 4.15 The data shows that in 2011 the 831 households in this area owned a total of 616 vehicles. Car ownership in 2011 in the area including the site is therefore 0.75 vehicles per household.

The modes of travel to work for the local working population from the 2011 census. The data shows that 51% of people drive to work and 10% are car passengers. Of the remainder, 15% use public transport, 14% walk and 4% cycle.

Mode of travel to work	Number	Percent
Work mainly at or from home	24	3%
Underground, metro, light rail, tram	2	0%
Train	21	2%
Bus, minibus or coach	137	15%
Taxi	7	1%
Motorcycle, scooter or moped	5	1%
Driving a car or van	467	51%
Passenger in a car or van	91	10%
Bicycle	36	4%
On foot	131	14%
Other method of travel to work	3	0%
All categories: Method of travel to work	924	100%

Mode of travel to work from 2011 census

5 Proposed Development

Introduction

The latest masterplan proposals are for demolition of side extension, ground floor rear extension and COU to 6 person HMO with associated bins & cycle facilities at 3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton, WV10 0AU.

Vehicle access

- 5.1 There is an existing access from Woden Road. The road is a residential road with parking on and off site. The access provides sight lines of 43m by 2.4m in both directions suitable for a 10-15 mph road and good intervisibility between pedestrians and vehicles entering or leaving. There is also a school on the road further down

Vehicle parking

- 5.2 There is no need for car parking, even though there is more than enough parking on the road. The shops, train station, hospital and doctors and bus stops are within walking distance of the site.
- 5.3 The existing houses is unoccupied and has no off street parking.
- 5.4 The site is in an accessible location suitable for low car ownership.

Pedestrian and cycle access

- 5.5 Pedestrian and cycle access to the existing housing is from Woden Road.
- 5.6 There are 6 cycle parking space for the HMO.

6 Summary and Conclusions

- 6.1 Vehicle access is at the same location as an existing and proposed crossover.
- 6.2 It is not expected that the development will lead to an increase in on-street parking because existing car ownership for local households is less than one space per dwelling and existing travel to work by car is 54% of all modes, according to the latest available census information.
- 6.3 The site is in a sustainable location with good pedestrian and cycle links to the surrounding area. There is access to a wide range of local facilities including schools, food shops, doctors, pharmacies, and employment. The closest bus stops are within 400 feet walk from the proposed site and there are buses 10 minutes per hour to many stops from Wolverhampton to Warstone and other prominent neighboring town sites
- 6.4 Safe and secure cycle parking is provided for both new and existing residents.
- 6.5 The city center and hospital and school are a short cycle ride (around 3 minutes' cycle) or walk (about 15 minutes' walk). This route is convenient and mostly on residential streets.
- 6.6 There are therefore no reasons for any objections on highway or transportation grounds.